

2 Thessalonians 2:13

But we are bound to give thanks alway to God for you, brethren beloved of the Lord, because God hath from the beginning chosen you to salvation through sanctification of the Spirit and belief of the truth:

- Verse 13 begins with “but” and that tells us that what follows it and what precedes it are connected.
- In English grammar, “but” is called a “coordinating conjunction”. That’s a fancy way of saying that it is a word that connects two or more words, phrases (incomplete sentences), or clauses (complete sentences).
- Other examples of coordinating conjunctions are: for, and, nor, or, yet, so.
- So, let’s have a look at what comes before verses 13 and 14 (which are one sentence) so we can identify what comes before and after the “but”.

2 Thessalonians 2:1-14

[1] Now we beseech you, brethren, by the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ, and by our gathering together unto him,

[2] That ye be not soon shaken in mind, or be troubled, neither by spirit, nor by word, nor by letter as from us, as that the day of Christ is at hand.

[3] Let no man deceive you by any means: for that day shall not come, except there come a falling away first, and that man of sin be revealed, the son of perdition;

[4] Who opposeth and exalteth himself above all that is called God, or that is worshipped; so that he as God sitteth in the temple of God, shewing himself that he is God.

[5] Remember ye not, that, when I was yet with you, I told you these things?

[6] And now ye know what withholdeth that he might be revealed in his time.

[7] For the mystery of iniquity doth already work: only he who now letteth will let, until he be taken out of the way.

[8] And then shall that Wicked be revealed, whom the Lord shall consume with the spirit of his mouth, and shall destroy with the brightness of his coming:

[9] Even him, whose coming is after the working of Satan with all power and signs and lying wonders,

[10] And with all deceivableness of unrighteousness in them that perish; because they received not the love of the truth, that they might be saved.

[11] And for this cause God shall send them strong delusion, that they should believe a lie:

[12] That they all might be damned who believed not the truth, but had pleasure in unrighteousness.

[13] **But** we are bound to give thanks alway to God for you, brethren beloved of the Lord, because God hath from the beginning chosen you to salvation through sanctification of the Spirit and belief of the truth:

[14] Whereunto he called you by our gospel, to the obtaining of the glory of our Lord Jesus Christ.

- This portion of the epistle from Paul (II Thess. 3:17) to the church at Thessalonica addresses concerns of that church with regards to the “day of Christ” also known as the second coming of our Lord Jesus Christ (I Thess. 4:15-18)
- What follows is a list of things that will happen before the return of Christ which reveals to both the church at Thessalonica and to us more details about the events leading up to His return.

Nouns/subjects before and after “but”

Verses 8-12		Verses 13,14
• That man of sin • the son of perdition • that Wicked • Satan • them that perish • (not) saved • damned (condemned) • believed not the truth • had pleasure in unrighteousness	but	• God • Brethren beloved of the Lord • (heirs of) salvation • (the) called • (heirs of) the glory of our Lord Jesus Christ

- Note that nothing in particular is said about the evil things except that they exist and some of them will be revealed at a later time ([Exodus 22:28a](#), [Ephesians 5:11,12](#)).
- “But we¹ are bound to give thanks” ... “to God for you” ... “because”
- 1. “God hath from the beginning chosen you to salvation” ([Ephesians 1:4-5](#), [2 Timothy 1:9](#), [1 Peter 1:2](#))
 - “through” (the means, the method)
 - sanctification (the act of making holy, the act of consecrating or of setting apart for a sacred purpose)
 - of the Spirit (God's spirit)
 - and belief of the truth (believing the gospel which saves)([Romans 10:10](#))
- When you look at an unsaved person do you feel the need to thank God that they aren't saved or do you instead rather feel you should pray that God would save them?
- When you look at a person that you know is saved does it feel appropriate to thank God for saving that person's soul?
- Likewise, in verse 13, Paul is expressing this never-ending thanks we can give to God not only for saving us but for anyone else. Once we are saved and learn the truth we realize that salvation is of God, He will finish what He started, and we are secure forever. A natural next step after realizing that is – what about everyone else?
- Now, put yourself in Paul's shoes. He traveled widely preaching the gospel and was an instrument used by God to establish quite a few of the early christian churches. His letters reveal that he cared deeply about the spiritual growth of the churches. Watching first hand, hearing about from others, and receiving letters from those churches was a bag of mixed emotions for Paul but the constant throughout his epistles is that he cared deeply about others. Seeing and hearing about people getting saved as a result of Paul preaching the gospel throughout the region was certainly a great joy for him ([Phil. 4:1](#)).
- It is in the context of that joy that Paul pens [II Thessalonians 2:13](#) of which we¹ also can join him in thanking God always for providing both the means and the method of reconciling men with their God.

¹ [II Thessalonians 3:17](#) (the end of the epistle) tells us that Paul wrote this letter with his own hand (singular). Who do you think the we (plural) is that he referred to?